Carolina Natural Solutions

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Ecommerce Website Development

GummyGurl.com

Issued By: Carolina Natural Solutions
Project: Consumer Retail E-commerce Platform Build
Industry: Hemp, Wellness, and Pet Products

1. Introduction

Carolina Natural Solutions is seeking proposals from qualified developers, agencies, or e-commerce specialists to design and build a modern e-commerce website for the **Gummy Gurl** consumer brand.

The objective is to develop a compliant, scalable e-commerce platform capable of supporting hemp-derived cannabinoid products alongside health, wellness, and pet product lines. The new platform should improve customer experience, operational efficiency, compliance visibility, and marketing capability while remaining competitive with leading brands in the hemp sector.

Primary reference sites include:

- **HempDoctor.com** (primary structural reference)
- **CannaBuddy.com**

These references reflect desired levels of professionalism, compliance presentation, and product organization.

2. Project Objectives

The primary goals of this project include:

- Modernizing our e-commerce presence
- Improving conversion rates and usability
- Enhancing mobile performance and site speed
- Strengthening compliance visibility and customer confidence
- Supporting scalable marketing, SEO, and retention initiatives
- Clearly segmenting product legality and categories
- Providing internal administrative control post-launch

3. Scope of Work

The selected vendor will design, develop, and deploy a fully functional e-commerce website including:

- Platform selection and configuration
- Theme customization/design implementation
- Product catalog setup and migration (if applicable)
- Payment processor integration
- Compliance functionality implementation
- SEO optimization
- Email marketing integration
- Analytics and advertising compatibility
- Quality assurance testing
- Launch support

4. Product Categories & Structure Requirements (+/- 35 products)

Hemp-Derived Products

- Delta-8 THC products
- Delta-9 hemp-derived THC products
- CBD products
- Edibles
- Tinctures
- Capsules
- Topicals

Health & Wellness Products

- Functional supplements
- Non-THC wellness products
- Plant-based wellness products
- Recovery/lifestyle products

Pet Products

- CBD pet treats

Compliance-Based Product Segmentation

The platform must:

- Clearly distinguish psychoactive vs non-psychoactive products
- Allow nationwide sales of wellness and pet products
- Restrict hemp cannabinoid sales by state legality
- Provide clear customer guidance regarding legality

5. Platform & Payment Requirements

The e-commerce platform must:

- Support integration with a hemp-compatible high-risk payment processor (e.g., Bankful or other applicable platform)
- Provide secure checkout functionality
- Support fraud prevention tools
- Integrate clearly with shipping and tax systems

Additionally, the platform should:

- Deduct minimal additional transaction or platform fees beyond payment processor costs
- Maintain compatibility with high-risk processors without excessive additional markups
- Provide stable checkout performance suitable for regulated product sales

Platform efficiency and fee structure are important evaluation criteria.

6. Compliance & Regulatory Requirements

The website must include:

- Age verification gate (21+)
- State-based purchase restrictions for regulated products
- Prominent legality disclaimers
- Certificates of Analysis (COAs) accessible on product pages
- Educational compliance information
- Strict avoidance of prohibited medical claims

COA accessibility should be clear, user-friendly, and transparent.

7. SEO & Content Optimization Requirements

The site should include:

- SEO-friendly site architecture
- Optimized metadata and structured headers
- Schema markup where appropriate
- Fast loading speeds
- Mobile-first responsive design
- Educational content/blog capability

Organic search performance is a key objective.

8. Email Marketing & Retention Integration

Required integrations include:

- Email newsletter platform compatibility (e.g., Klaviyo)
- Automated welcome sequences
- Abandoned cart automation
- Subscription/recurring purchase functionality
- Referral or loyalty program capability

These tools are essential due to advertising limitations in the hemp industry.

9. Reviews & Social Proof Features

The website must include:

- Verified customer review capability
- Product star ratings
- Automated review request workflows
- Optional photo review support

These features are critical for consumer trust.

10. Social Media & Advertising Compatibility

The platform must support:

- Meta Pixel integration
- Google Analytics and tracking tools
- Conversion tracking compatibility
- Social media advertising readiness
- Influencer campaign compatibility

Accurate tracking and attribution are required.

11. Design & User Experience Requirements

The website should:

- Present a modern, competitive appearance within the hemp sector
- Be clean, professional, and user-friendly
- Optimize mobile usability
- Focus on conversion efficiency
- Maintain clear product organization

We will provide:

- Product photography
- Packaging visuals
- Product information
- Compliance documentation

We require collaborative design review opportunities throughout the project.

12. Backend Access & Administrative Control

Post-launch requirements include:

- Full administrative backend access
- Ability to add/edit products independently
- Ability to update content and blog posts
- Ability to manage compliance messaging
- Ability to maintain SEO content internally

Ongoing developer dependency for routine updates is not desired.

13. Current Website Limitations

Our current website (CarolinaNaturalSolutions.com) has several limitations that this project should address:

- Outdated visual presentation compared to competitors
- Slower performance and checkout experience
- Mixed messaging between manufacturing and retail functions
- Less optimized product organization
- Limited advertising flexibility associated with existing domain
- Reduced competitive positioning in e-commerce presentation

14. Additional Desired Features

We are interested in:

- Effects-based product filtering (Relax, Sleep, Focus, etc.)
- Product bundle builders
- Recommended product suggestions
- FAQ and educational resources
- Clear shipping and compliance transparency
- Subscription discount functionality
- Rotating discount and promotional pop-ups
- Loyalty program capability
- Trust badges near checkout

Additional best-practice recommendations are welcome.

15. Proposal Submission Requirements

Proposals should include:

- Relevant e-commerce experience (preferably hemp/CBD sector)
- Proposed platform recommendation
- Estimated timeline
- Development approach
- Examples of similar work
- Post-launch support options
- Fee structure and pricing model

16. Evaluation Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated based on:

- Relevant industry experience
- Compliance understanding
- Platform expertise
- Design and UX capability
- Cost efficiency and transparency
- Timeline feasibility
- Communication and collaboration approach

Conclusion

This project represents a strategic modernization of our consumer e-commerce presence. The goal is to improve operational efficiency, compliance clarity, customer experience, and market competitiveness within the hemp and wellness sector.

We look forward to reviewing proposals from qualified partners capable of delivering a compliant, high-performance e-commerce platform.